

♩ = 160

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Joseph Barnby

(1838-96)

## O little town of Bethlehem (III)

86. 86. 76. 86

Phillips Brooks

(1835-93)

simply

First system of the musical score. It consists of a treble and a bass staff. The treble staff has a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat) and a 3/2 time signature. The bass staff has a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat) and a 2/2 time signature. The music is in a simple, hymn-like style. Dynamics include *p* (piano), *cresc.* (crescendo), and *dim.* (diminuendo).

Second system of the musical score, starting at measure 13. It includes lyrics for three verses. The music continues in the same style as the first system. Dynamics include *mf* (mezzo-forte), *cresc.* (crescendo), and *f* (forte).

13

*mf* *cresc.* *f*

1 O little town of Bethlehem,  
how still we see thee lie!  
above thy deep and dreamless sleep  
the silent stars go by:  
yet in thy dark streets shineth  
the everlasting Light;  
the hopes and fears of all the years  
are met in thee tonight.

2 O morning stars, together  
proclaim the holy birth,  
and praises sing to God the King,  
and peace to men on earth.  
For Christ is born of Mary;  
and, gathered all above,  
while mortals sleep, the angels keep  
their watch of wondering love.

3 How silently, how silently,  
the wondrous gift is given!  
so God imparts to human hearts  
the blessings of his heaven.  
No ear may hear his coming;  
but in this world of sin,  
where meek souls will receive him, so  
the dear Christ enters in.

4 O holy Child of Bethlehem,  
descend to us, we pray;  
cast out our sin, and enter in:  
be born in us today.  
We hear the Christmas angels  
the great glad tidings tell:  
O come to us, abide with us,  
our Lord Emmanuel.

*mf* *f*

Third system of the musical score, starting at measure 22. It continues the melody and accompaniment. The system ends with a double bar line.

22